

Rewarded-ad ideas for AOL

1. **Product change** 30 minutes of reading with no ads, sponsored by one brand

Each idea takes two slides: its whole flow, step by step, then why it works. The score pages at the end score every idea the review saw.

In every idea the user chooses to play. The reward comes once, only after the play is verified, and closing the game or a failed ad uses nothing up.

No idea passed every check, so the closest is drawn and marked as not a recommendation.

3 idea(s) split the reviewers, so they aren't drawn; the Needs your call page at the end lists them.

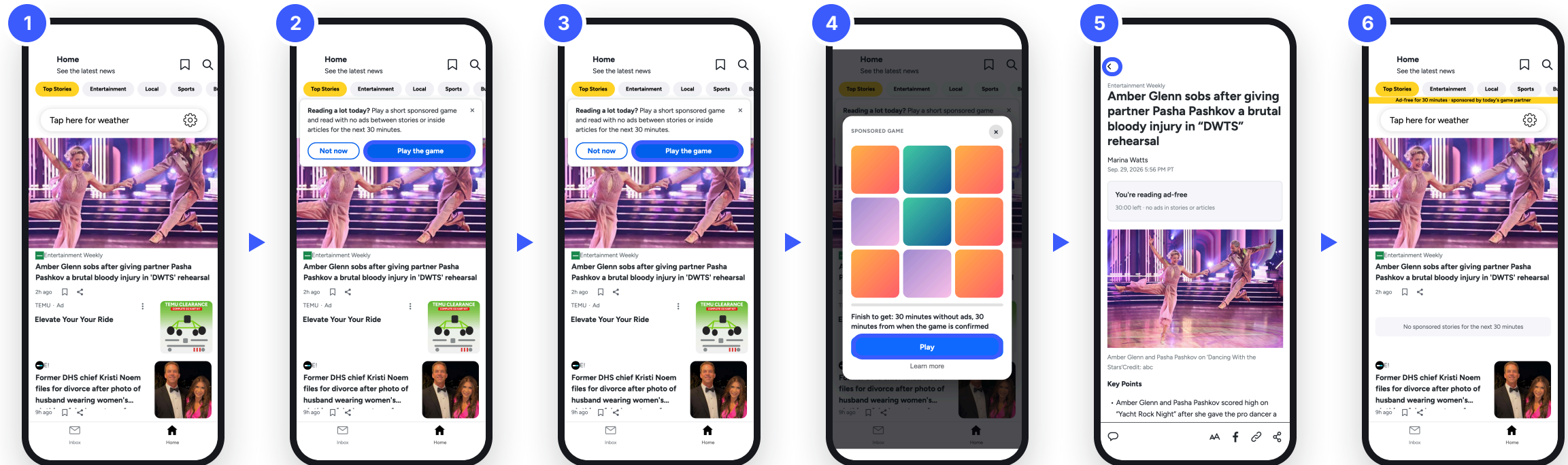
The mock step finished only part of its work: 25 screens not drawn (Article: Noem More from E! Online, Article: Noem statement section, Article: Noem photo section and 22 more): over the mock's budget.

The qa step finished only part of its work: the mock left screens undrawn: s39, s40, s41, s42, s43, s44, s45, s46, s47, s48, s49, s50, s51, s52, s53, s54, s55, s56, s57, s58, s59, s60, s61, s62, s08 (over the \$ budget): core flows through an undrawn screen:

30 minutes of reading with no ads, sponsored by one brand

The new part: A dismissible banner on the home feed that offers 30 minutes without sponsored cards or in-article ads in exchange for one short sponsored game, with a small line crediting the game's brand during that time.

The offer says: "Reading a lot today? Play a short sponsored game and read with no ads between stories or inside articles for the next 30 minutes." Saying no changes nothing.



TODAY

The home feed as it is today, with sponsored cards between the top stories.

WHEN IT APPEARS

The user comes back to the home feed after opening their third article of the day.

THE OFFER

After the third article of the day, a banner under the header offers 30 ad-free minutes for one short game.

THE AD PLAYS

The user plays a short game from the sponsoring brand and can close it at any time.

WHAT THEY GET

Articles open without the card under the byline or ads in the body, and the 30-minute timer starts.

WHAT THEY GET

The feed shows no sponsored cards, and a thin line at the top says who sponsored this ad-free half hour.

They get: 30 minutes without ads, 30 minutes from when the game is confirmed · **How often:** 1 per day, resets at midnight local time

Why this works for your app

WHAT THE USER GETS

30 minutes without ads, 30 minutes from when the game is confirmed.

WHAT THE APP GETS

Readers who open several articles in a row scroll past a sponsored card under every byline and several ad blocks inside each story, so a clean half hour is worth one short game to them. The app replaces a stretch of low-value card and block impressions with one opted-in game that earns more. The sponsoring brand gets full attention and a labeled credit line, which is more than a card users scroll past.

WHAT IT NEVER COSTS THEM

Nothing free is taken away, and saying no changes nothing. Every user sees the same offer.

Reach scenario, not a measurement: the offer sits on the first screen people see, and appears only when this happens: The user comes back to the home feed after opening their third article of the day.

Closest idea: The reviewers split on "backed by what was seen in the app"; confirm it before building. "backed by what was seen in the app": one reviewer: no (The 'what makes it work here' field claims the ad value displaced by a half hour is low. Mechanics m1 and m2 establish where ads appear, but do not support a claim about their current value); another: yes (The claims about today's app are supported by the model: feed cards (m1), cards under the byline and in-body ADVERTISEMENT blocks (m2,,,, and TEMU rotation. The no-paid-plan and paywall statements are worded as not seen, matching m4 and the open questions).

Cost check (CONDITIONAL): a view pays for what it costs to serve only where ad prices are high. The review's cost line has the numbers.

When the reward runs out: When the 30 minutes end, a small note says the usual stories and ads are back and the ad-free half hour can be earned again tomorrow, which gives heavy readers a reason to come back daily.

Every idea the review scored

Idea	Title	Verdict	Checks	Why
c07	30 minutes of reading with no ads, sponsored by one brand	conditional	10/11	didn't pass backed by what was seen in the app; cost check: a view pays for what it costs to serve only where ad prices are high
c02	Save your reading streak after missing a day	conditional	10/11	didn't pass people already value what it gives
c06	Open straight to your favorite section for 7 days	conditional	10/11	didn't pass backed by what was seen in the app
c09	Pick which kinds of sponsored stories you see for 7 days	conditional	9/11	didn't pass people already value what it gives, backed by what was seen in the app
c03	15 minutes of stories without the ad blocks inside	rejected	10/11	didn't pass backed by what was seen in the app; cost check: a view pays for what it costs to serve only where ad prices are high
c01	Read stories without ads for 20 minutes	rejected	10/11	dropped by code: duplicate of c07: same benefit (ad-free reading); didn't pass backed by what was seen in the app; cost check: a view pays for what it costs to serve only where ad prices are high
c08	30 minutes of articles without the advertisement blocks	rejected	10/11	dropped by code: duplicate of c07: same benefit (ad-free reading); didn't pass backed by what was seen in the app; cost check: a view pays for what it costs to serve only where ad prices are high
c03-rev	15 minutes of stories without the ad blocks inside	rejected	10/11	dropped by code: duplicate of c07: same benefit (temporary ad-free reading); didn't pass the right moment; cost check: a view pays for what it costs to serve only where ad prices are high; a revision of c03
c04	Keep your reading streak after a missed day	rejected	10/11	dropped by code: duplicate of c02: same benefit (reading streak save); didn't pass people already value what it gives
c05	Keep your reading streak after a missed day	rejected	9/11	dropped by code: duplicate of c02: same benefit (reading streak save); didn't pass backed by what was seen in the app, fits a rewarded game

Every judge's reasoning for every check, and every cost line with its numbers: [exhibits/06-judge.md](#). Tap through any idea: [flows/<idea>/index.html](#).

Needs your call

- **c02 · Save your reading streak after missing a day**

"people already value what it gives": one reviewer: no (As a product_change, the new resource (a streak save) is not a slice of anything the app charges for. It is also not something the player uses in an observed core flow (f1 to f6 are reading, sign-in, receipts and search). It only protects a counter the proposal itself invents); another: yes (As a product change, the save protects the reader's own streak earned by opening stories, an action in the observed reading flows f1 and f2).

To approve: {"id": "c02", "splits": ["c1_revealed_value"]}

- **c06 · Open straight to your favorite section for 7 days**

"backed by what was seen in the app": one reviewer: no (The 'what makes it work here' field says the home feed always opens on Top Stories, and the decline field says it keeps doing so today. shows Top Stories selected on an observed screen, but does not establish behavior on every app opening); another: yes (The claims about the app today are supported. shows Top Stories selected with the other tabs beside it to. The absence of a way to change the opening tab is worded as 'not seen in the explored screens'. The new card, setting and copy are what the proposal itself adds).

To approve: {"id": "c06", "splits": ["c2_evidence"]}

- **c09 · Pick which kinds of sponsored stories you see for 7 days**

"people already value what it gives": one reviewer: no (This is a product_change. The new resource is a say over which ads appear. It is not a slice of anything the app charges for, and it is not used in a core flow the model observed, since reading articles (f1, f2) is unaffected. The proposal itself says it mainly helps advertisers reach chosen readers, so the player gets little of the value); another: yes (This product change gives the reader a choice they use in the home feed, which is part of the observed story-reading flows f1 and f2. The benefit is not predominantly given to another person).

"backed by what was seen in the app": one reviewer: no (The 'what makes it work here' field presents the quoted TEMU jacket deal as part of the home feed's sponsor mix, but that headline is observed on article, not home-feed card. Its claim that car accessories are among the observed sponsors is also unsupported by's 'Elevate Your Your Ride' headline); another: yes (Rotating Taboola sponsors and cards between stories are supported by m1 and the cited// elements. The claim that readers can't steer the mix is worded as 'not seen in any explored screen', and the open question about the more-options menu is acknowledged. The new card, counters and copy are the proposal's own additions).

To approve: {"id": "c09", "splits": ["c1_revealed_value", "c2_evidence"]}

The reviewers split on these ideas, so none is drawn. To draw one, add its "To approve" entry to the list in **flows/approvals.json** and run flows again.